

ATTAWAT ASSAVANADDA (馬臣義)

Email attawat@connect.hku.hk

EDUCATION

2021 – 2026, **PhD**, Political Science, The University of Hong Kong, HKSAR
Advisors: Austin Strange (primary); Kai Quek (secondary)
2018 – 2020, **MA**, International Relations, Waseda University, JAPAN
Advisor: Chikako Kawakatsu Ueki
2013 – 2017, **BA (Honours)**, Political Science, Chulalongkorn University, THAILAND

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

PhD THESIS

Three Essays on Chinese Ethnicity and Attitudes Towards China: Psychological Insights from Thailand
Thesis Examining Committee: Prof. Dove H. Levin, Prof. Enze Han, Prof. Alice Ba (external examiner)

ACADEMIC PAPERS

Revise and Resubmit

- “‘Yes, we are family, but ...’: Thai receptions of ‘Thai-China are the same family’ narrative” at *International Journal of Strategic Communication*
- “Is Soft Power a Zero-sum Competition?” With Austin Strange and Samuel Chan at *International Studies Quarterly*

Under review

- “What does China’s rise mean to ethnic Chinese overseas? A qualitative study of Sino-Thais”
- “Three-dimensional outcomes of moral-identity branding in foreign political marketing: Experimental evidence from China’s public diplomacy in Thailand”
- “Hearts and minds across borders: Chinese ethnic identity and political support for China in Thailand”
- “‘Yes, we are family, but ...’: Thai receptions of ‘Thai-China are the same family’ narrative”

Work-in-progress

- “Popular hedging in Thailand: The societal foundations of strategic flexibility amid Sino-US rivalry” accepted for presentation at *the 2026 ISA-Asia Pacific Conference, New Delhi, India*
- “Who are we to each other? Conceptualizing discursive construction of interstate bilateral relations” With Gao Xirui (HKU)—accepted for presentation at *the 2026 APSA Annual Conference*
- “Telling China’s stories well? Digital diplomacy, narrative strategies, and Chinese embassies’ Facebook communication in Southeast Asia, 2018–2025” With Mon Madomitsu (UTokyo) and Maria Elize H. Mendoza (UP Diliman)
- China’s digital public diplomacy in the Global South: State of the field and ways forward (book chapter proposal submitted for consideration at *Research Handbook on Communication in China*).

POLICY AND OTHER WRITING

Policy Paper

“Soft power, deterrence, and South Korea’s national security,” in *Shaping the Future of Security on the Korean Peninsula: Next-Generation Policy Perspectives* (February 2025), New York: The National Committee on American Foreign Policy.

“Thailand’s Brain Drain Challenge: Trends and Implications,” in *Issues & Insights Vol. 23, SR6 –Pressing Security Concerns in Southeast Asia: Next-Generation Perspectives* (June 2023), Honolulu, HI: Pacific Forum.

Book Review

Review of “China’s Asian Dream: Empire Building along the New Silk Road” by Tom Miller.
International Journal of China Studies 9, no.2 (August 2018): 251-253.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tutor (Teaching Assistant) ***I am a certified tutor by HKU and an Associate Fellow of AdvanceHE (UK)**

HKU: School of Future Media [Spring 2025-26]

CCCH9062 Encoding and Decoding China in International News

(taught by Prof. Alejandro Reyes)

Overall Tutoring Effectiveness 93.6%

- Design and implement 10 activity-based, AI-embraced classes per week for 10 weeks (50 minutes/class)
- Equip students with literacy and critical thinking through analyses of global media reporting China
- Help improve students’ presentation skills by arranging training and rehearsal sessions
- Help improve students’ teamworking skills by implementing in-class group projects and discussions
- Number of enrolled students = 118

HKU: Department of Politics and Public Administration [Spring 2022-23]

POLI3052 International relations of East Asia

(taught by Prof. Enze Han)

Overall Tutoring Effectiveness 86.4%

- Design and implement 10 discussion-based classes per week for 10 weeks (50 minutes/class)
- Equip students with state-of-the-art knowledge through discussions of research articles
- Help improve students’ communication skills by arranging group discussions and debates
- Help improve students’ research skills by integrating short quizzes into every class
- Number of enrolled students = 104

CONFERENCES AND TALKS

Regular Conferences

American Political Science Association (APSA)	2024, 2025, 2026 (accepted)
International Studies Association (ISA)	2025, 2026
International Studies Association, Asia-Pacific (ISA-AP)	2023, 2026 (accepted)
International Political Science Association (IPSA)	2025
International Society for Political Psychology (ISPP)	2026 (accepted)

Academic Workshops

2026

IPSA Work-in-Progress Session (accepted)

2025

APSA Southeast Asia Research Development Group (SEA-RDG), Vancouver, Canada

Association of Southeast Asian Studies – United Kingdom (ASEAS-UK) PhD Workshop, Bangkok, Thailand

Duke University’s Southeast Asia Research Group (SEAREG), Bangkok, Thailand

2024

APSA (SEA-RDG), Philadelphia, PA, USA

CUHK Workshop on Political Psychology in East Asia, Hong Kong SAR

Policy Symposia

2024

The Manila Dialogue on the South China Sea, the Philippines

Pacific Forum Research Showcase, Honolulu, HI, USA [online]

The National Committee on American Foreign Policy (NCAFP), New York, USA

2023

The US-ASEAN Futures Symposium, Washington DC, USA

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

HKU Postgraduate Scholarship (PGS)

Sep 2021 – Aug 2025

Japanese Government Scholarship (Monbukagakusho: MEXT)

Oct 2018 – Sep 2020

Taiwanese Government Scholarship (Huayu Enrichment: HES)

2020/21 *cancelled due to pandemic

2025

SEAREG Fellowship

Full sponsorship

APSA, SEA-RDG

USD1000

HKU, Travel Support

HKD13500

2024

NCAFP

Full sponsorship

APSA, SEA-RDG

USD1000

HKU, Department of Politics and Public Administration's Departmental Fund

HKD16000

HKU, Travel Support

HKD13500

2023

Pacific Forum

Full sponsorship

APSA, Political Scientist Training Academy

Full sponsorship

Hong Kong Government, Reaching Out Award

HKD10000

IPSA, Travel Grant

USD500

2019

Haraguchi Memorial Asia Research Fund, Research Grant

JPY 221,000

ADDITIONAL ACADEMIC TRAINING

2025

University of British Columbia

Short-term Visiting PhD Student (hosted by Kai Ostwald)

IPSA – Pre-Conference Methods Workshop

“Text as Data”

2024

IPSA – NUS Methods School

“Modern Regression Analysis”

HKU Methods Hub

“Quantitative Data Analysis in the Social Sciences”

HKU Graduate School

“Qualitative Research Methods Workshops”

2023

IPSA – NUS Methods School

“Survey Research” and “Mixed Methods Research”

New York University at Shanghai

“Introduction to Computational Social Science”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The German-Southeast Asian Center of Excellence for Public Policy and Good Governance

Oct 2020 – Apr 2021

Research Assistant

Chinese Studies Centre, Institute of Asian Studies, Chulalongkorn University

Feb 2018 – Aug 2018

Research Assistant

Government House of Thailand (Office of the Advisor to the Deputy Prime Minister for Security Affairs)	
Aug 2017 – Jan 2018	Political Analyst
The University of New South Wales	
Mar 2016 – Aug 2016	Research Intern

EXTERNAL AFFILIATIONS

Pacific Forum, Honolulu, Hawai'i, USA

November 2024 – Present

June 2021 – Present

Head, Bangkok Chapter of the Young Leader Program
Young Leader

National Committee on American Foreign Policy, New York, USA

May 2024 – February 2025

Next-Generation Korea Peninsula Specialists

Young China Watchers International

Feb 2022 – Mar 2023

Global Editorial Team

Nov 2020 – Jan 2022

Freelance Writer

MEMBERSHIPS

APSA, IPSA, ISA, ASEAS-UK, International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP), Association of Asian Studies (AAS)

SERVICES

Reviewer: *Review of International Studies*

Chair (c) and Discussant (d): *International Studies Association Virtual 2026 (c, d); International Studies Association Asia-Pacific Conference 2023 (c)*

LANGUAGES

Thai (Native), English (Professional), Mandarin Chinese (Upper Intermediate), Cantonese (Conversational) and Japanese (Conversational)

SOFTWARE

SPSS, Stata, R Studio, qualtrics^{XM}

FIELDWORK AND RESEARCH TRAVEL

Taiwan (2020); Thailand (Feb and Jul-Aug 2024)

REFEREES

Austin Strange

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Kai Ostwald

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Research and Teaching Referee

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Teaching Referee

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